Leader resource · all seven posted studies · NKJV

2 Thessalonians: Charts from the Seven Studies

Every chart from the seven 2 Thessalonians studies, in study order — one section per study, with leader notes on every slide.

The series at a glance (1 of 2)

Studies 1–4

#	Passage	Title	In brief
1	1:1–2	**Introduction and Background**	The road to Thessalonica, the founding team, and a church that lives “in God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.”
2	1:3–12	**Paul’s Admiration for the Thessalonians**	A faith that grows exceedingly, a love that reaches each one, and a righteous Judge who will set things right.
3	2:1–5	**Confusion Concerning the Coming**	Shaken by a false spirit, word, and letter — Paul’s correction: the apostasy and the man of sin must come first.
4	2:6–12	**The Removal of the Restrainer**	The mystery of lawlessness, the Restrainer taken out of the way, and the lawless one destroyed at Christ’s coming.

The series at a glance (2 of 2)

Studies 5–7

#	Passage	Title	In brief
5	2:13–17	**The Day of the Lord and Believers**	Chosen, set apart, and appointed to deliverance — so stand fast and hold the apostolic Word.
6	3:1–12	**Serving While Waiting**	Wait on the Lord in prayer and wait for the Lord in work — the Word must run, and idleness must not become meddling.
7	3:13–18	**My Brother’s Keeper**	Am I my brother’s keeper? Don’t grow weary in doing good, admonish as family, and rest in the Lord of peace.

Study 1 of 7 · 2 Thessalonians 1:1–2

Introduction and Background

Before Paul says one word about persecution, prophecy, or correction, he reminds a young, suffering church where it came from and who it is — a church “in God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.”

The road to Thessalonica

B · The background geographically (Acts 15:36–18:11)

A

The team

Paul and Silas; Timothy joins at Lystra

Acts 15:36–16:3

B

Troas

Doors closed — then the Macedonian call

Acts 16:6–10

C

Philippi

“Believe on the Lord Jesus Christ, and you will be saved”

Acts 16:16–34

D

Thessalonica

Three Sabbaths in the synagogue — and more

Acts 17:1–9

E

Corinth

Berea and Athens, then Corinth — where both letters were written

Acts 17:10–18:11

What Paul taught new believers

- Prophecy — “Jesus is coming”
- And it strengthened them

Why a second letter? · Study Note

- Persecution had intensified (1:4–7)
- A false claim the Day had come (2:1–2)
- Some had stopped working (3:6–12)

Three men, one letter

2 Thessalonians 1:1a · C.1 — Paul and his companions

Paul Παῦλος G3972	Silvanus Σιλουανός G4610	Timothy Τιμόθεος G5095
• Just “Paul” — no title • Their friend, the one they loved • Contrast Galatians 1:1	• The senior member (Silas) • Jerusalem leader, prophet, Roman citizen • A co-founder of this church	• The leader in training • Sent back to establish them (1 Thess 3:2) • Later pastor at Ephesus

Paul comes to this church as a friend, not as an authority enforcing correction.

The church’s true address

2 Thessalonians 1:1b · C.2.a–c — The church, in God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ

A

Any assembly

A secular word — even Diana’s worshipers

Acts 19:32

B

Church universal

“I will build My church” — Pentecost to Rapture

Matt 16:18

C

Local church

“Tell it to the church”

Matt 18:17

D

Of the Thessalonians

Identified by its people, not a building

ἐκκλησία · 1:1

In God our Father
ἐν · πατήρ in · Father

- Security, love, strength
- “our Father” — not just “the Father”

And the Lord Jesus Christ
κύριος · Ἰησοῦς · Χριστός

- Lord — deity · Jesus — deliverer
- Christ — Messiah, the Anointed One

Grace and peace — from one source

2 Thessalonians 1:2 · C.2.d–e — The greeting and its source

Grace
χάρις charis · G5485

- Not just unmerited favor —
- favor in spite of demerit
- We deserve judgment; He gives grace

Peace
εἰρήνη eirēnē · G1515

- Shalom: wholeness, welfare
- Peace with God — settled at faith
- The peace of God — for daily trouble

From
ἀπό apo · G575

- One preposition governs both persons
- Father and Son — one source
- A witness to Christ's deity

Grace and peace frame the whole letter (1:2; 3:16, 18) — the persecution of chapter 1, the prophecy of chapter 2, and the correction of chapter 3.

Discuss and apply

2 Thessalonians 1:1–2 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. Paul writes simply “Paul,” not “Paul the apostle.” Why does that matter here, and how does it compare with Galatians and Corinthians?

2. How does the teacher define grace, and what does peace mean? Why does grace come before peace?

Apply

Live at Your True Address
Write “in God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ” on a card and keep it where you’ll see it each morning.

Receive Favor in Spite of Demerit
Each day this week, thank God by name for one specific grace you did not deserve.

In one line: Before any correction, Paul reminds a suffering church who it is — in God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ, under grace and peace.

Study 2 of 7 · 2 Thessalonians 1:3–12

Paul’s Admiration for the Thessalonians

A faith growing under testing, a love that reaches each one, endurance worth boasting about — and to such a church God gives an undisputed promise and Paul an undefeated prayer.

Praise, promise, prayer

2 Thessalonians 1:3–12 · Outline I–III

I · Undiluted praise · 3–4

- Bound to give thanks
- For growth — faith
- For grace — love
- For glory — boasting

II · Undisputed promise · 5–10

- The proof: judgment of saints and sinners
- The present: rest
- The prospect: revelation, revenge, reward

III · Undefeated prayer · 11–12

- Always, to our God
- Counted worthy of the calling
- His name glorified in you

What is the promise? God is in control. Every situation you find yourself in, God is in control.

Why Paul was bound to give thanks

2 Thessalonians 1:3–4 · I.A–B — A word of undiluted praise

For growth · 3b
ὑπεραυξάνω grows exceedingly

- Tested exceedingly → growing exceedingly
- Like muscles at the gym
- Like the oak in the wind

For grace · 3c
ἕκαστος each one · G1538

- Love “of each one of you all”
- A nickel for each — not for everybody
- Leave no one out

For glory · 4
καυχάομαι boast · G2744

- Paul boasted of them at Corinth
- Their patience and faith in persecution
- Are we spreading the word?

ὀφείλω “we are bound” — a debt Paul owed God every time he thought of this church (again in 2:13)

Entering the kingdom — and ruling in it

2 Thessalonians 1:5–6 · II.A — The proof of the promise

Judgment of saints · v.5

καταξιόω counted worthy · G2661

- Every believer enters the kingdom (John 5:24)
- Faithful sufferers are counted worthy to rule
- At the Judgment Seat of Christ — not for sin
- The believer gets the reward; God the glory

vs

Judgment of sinners · v.6

- God repays with tribulation those who trouble you
- They are amateurs; God is the professional
- Meanwhile, give them the Word
- Saul heard Stephen — and the Lord got him

"If we endure, we shall also reign with Him" (2 Tim 2:12). Entrance is by faith alone; reigning is a reward for faithful endurance.

Rest now — revelation, revenge, reward to come

2 Thessalonians 1:7–10 · II.B–C — The present and the prospect

v.7a	Rest with us — relief: resting in Jesus for the outcome	**ἄνεσις** relaxation, relief
v.7b	Revealed from heaven with His mighty angels — the Second Coming	**ἀποκάλυψις** a public unveiling
v.8	Vengeance on those who don’t know God and don’t obey the gospel	**—** two groups, one outcome
v.9	Everlasting destruction from the presence of the Lord	**ὄλεθρος · αἰώνιος** as long as everlasting life
v.10	Glorified in His saints, admired among all who believe	**ἐνδοξάζομαι** in His saints — “in, not by”

Coming for His saints — or with them?

2 Thessalonians 1:7–10 · Study Note — Rapture or Second Coming?

The Rapture	vs	The Second Coming · 1:7–10
• He comes for His saints • Meets them in the air (1 Thess 4:16–17) • No judgment on the world mentioned		• He comes with His saints and mighty angels • To the earth, in flaming fire, in judgment • At the end of the Tribulation

Believers on the earth will look at the church returning with Him and see Christ in us. We can’t make His name more glorious — but we can make His glory more well known.

A word of undefeated prayer

2 Thessalonians 1:11–12 · III.A–B — When and what Paul prayed

A

Always

To our God — theirs and ours

v.11a

B

Counted worthy

Of the high calling, in the Spirit's power

ἀξιόω · v.11b

C

His name glorified

In you, and you in Him

v.12

D

Stand firm

Don't run from affliction

by grace

"What was true for the church at Thessalonica is certainly the standard for all of us" — a faithful life that honors His name as we look for His coming.

Discuss and apply

2 Thessalonians 1:3–12 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. Why was the Thessalonians' faith growing "exceedingly," and what illustrations does the teacher use?

2. How does the teacher explain being "counted worthy of the kingdom of God" (1:5)?

Apply

Welcome the Wind
Name one current trial in prayer each day this week and thank God for the faith He is building through it.

Rest — God's Got Your Back
Memorize 2 Thessalonians 1:7a and pray it whenever pressure comes.

In one line: Tested faith grows, love reaches each one, God will set things right — so rest in Him and let His name be glorified in you.

Study 3 of 7 · 2 Thessalonians 2:1–5

Confusion Concerning the Coming

Shaken by a false spirit, a fabricated prophecy and a forged letter, the Thessalonians feared the Day of the Lord had come. Paul's correction: the apostasy and the man of sin must come first — and the antidote is to remember.

Two days distinguished

Introduction · The Rapture and the Day of the Lord

The Rapture — “the Day of Christ”
παρουσία · ἐπισυναγωγή coming · gathering together

- The church taken out — in a moment
- The dead raised, the living caught up
- 1 Thess 4:16–18

vs

The Day of the Lord

- Judgment — seven years
- Blessing — one thousand years
- For the Christ-rejecting world
- 1 Thess 5:1–3

The Rapture comes before the Day of the Lord — but it does not start it. The Day of the Lord starts later, when the man of sin is revealed.

Three channels of deception

2 Thessalonians 2:1–2 · I — The confusion by apostates

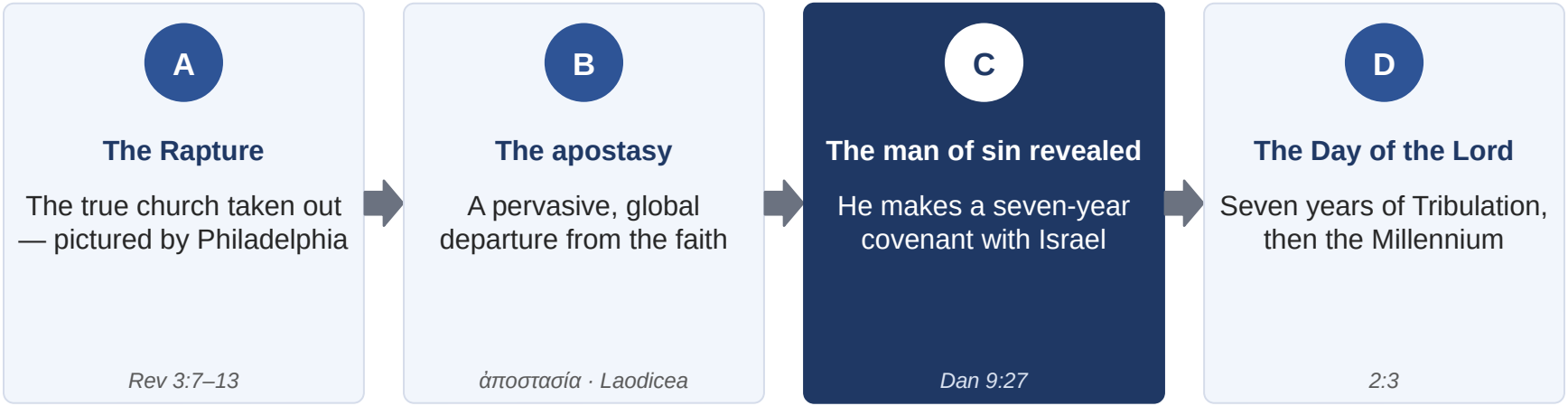
By spirit	By word	By letter ἐπιστολή letter · G1992
• A false message in tongues • Test the spirits (1 John 4:1)	• A fabricated prophecy • Errors can occur in any gift	• Forged — “as if from us” • Paul signs every letter (3:17)

The claim · ἐνίστημι: not that the Day was near, but that it was already here — “you missed the Rapture.”

Behind all three: Satan, the great deceiver. Don’t be shaken in mind (σαλεύω) or troubled in emotion (θροέω).

What must come first

2 Thessalonians 2:3–4 · II.A — The error of the deception



Walvoord: “Paul was declaring that the Day of the Lord cannot come until first a pervasive, global departure from the faith.” Study Note: some pretribulationists read apostasia as the Rapture itself — either way, the church is not in that Day.

The man of sin: his aliases

Conclusion · Other names for the “son of perdition,” the final world dictator

Dan 7–9	The little horn · a king of fierce countenance · the prince who is to come	— Dan 7:8; 8:23; 9:26
Dan 9–11	The one who makes desolate · the willful king	— Dan 9:27; 11:36–45
Zech 11	A foolish shepherd	— Zech 11:15–17
2 Thess 2	The man of sin · the son of perdition · the lawless (wicked) one	**ἁμαρτία · ἀπώλεια** 2:3, 8
Rev 6, 13	The rider on the white horse · the beast out of the sea	— Rev 6:2; 13:1–2

His agenda — revealed now, doing these things later

2 Thessalonians 2:4 · II.A.2.b–d — His description

A **Opposes God**

Against the true God, Jehovah

B **Above God**

Claims the worship that belongs to Jehovah only

C **Above all gods**

No other religion allowed — worship him or die

D **Sits in the temple**

ναός — at the midpoint of the Tribulation (Dan 9:27)

E **Shows himself God**

“I am God” — over the whole world

✓ **A picture: 167 B.C.**

Antiochus Epiphanes set Zeus — with his own face — in the temple

“Do you not remember?”

2 Thessalonians 2:5 · II.B — The antidote for the deception

A

Hear it

Pay attention to what you hear

first

B

Review it

Think about it during the week

often

C

Teach it

Explain it to family and friends

“you’ll know it when you teach it”

The antidote to every deception: remember, review, and teach what God has already said. You are not going into that Tribulation.

Discuss and apply

2 Thessalonians 2:1–5 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. What three channels did the deception come through, and how should believers guard against each?

2. What two things must happen before the Day of the Lord can begin, and how will the man of sin be revealed?

Apply

Test What You Hear
Take one prophecy claim you've heard and look up the passages yourself before accepting it.

Teach It to Keep It
Explain the difference between the Rapture and the Day of the Lord to a family member or friend this week.

In one line: Don't be shaken: the apostasy and the man of sin must come first — so remember, review and teach what God has said.

Study 4 of 7 · 2 Thessalonians 2:6–12

The Removal of the Restrainer

The apostasy, the man of sin — and a third thing must come first: the Restrainer taken out of the way. Then the lawless one is revealed, and the Lord Jesus destroys him at His coming. God is in control from beginning to end.

Three reasons they were not in the Day

Introduction · A–D

1 · The apostasy

- A falling away from the faith
- Worldwide and church-wide
- Studied in 2:3

2 · The man of sin revealed

- A seven-year covenant with Israel
- Dan 9:27
- Israel's prophecy clock restarts

3 · The Restrainer removed

- "Until He is taken out of the way"
- 2:6–7
- Today's study

"Do you not remember that when I was with you I told you these things?" (2:5) — Paul expected them to remember what he taught them. And why not?

Who is the Restrainer?

2 Thessalonians 2:6–7 · I.A and I.C — A force and a person

v.6 — “what is restraining”
τὸ κατέχον neuter

- A force — a “what”
- Fits pneuma, a neuter noun
- Must be strong enough to hold back Satan

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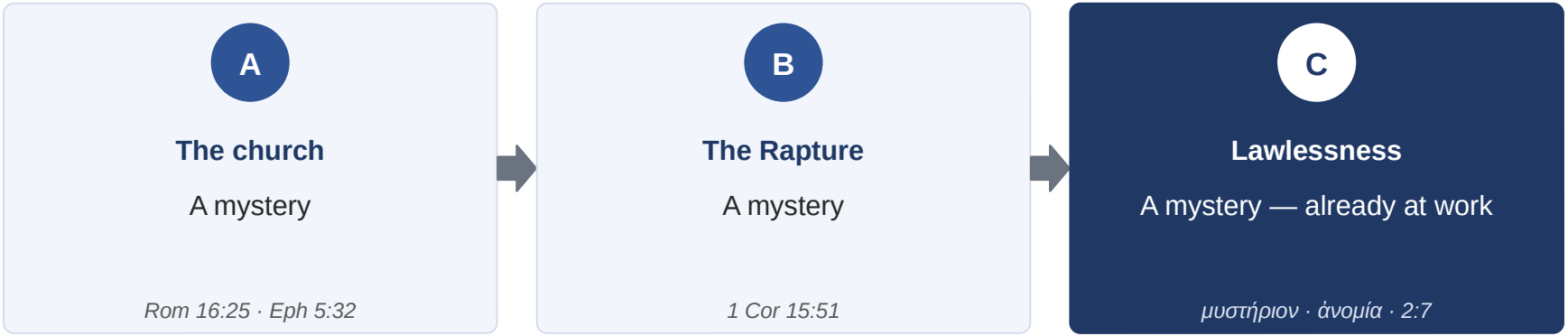
v.7 — “He who now restrains”
ὁ κατέχων masculine

- A person — a “He”
- As Jesus spoke of the Spirit (John 14–16)
- Indwells the church until removed

The Spirit cannot leave a believer (“forever,” John 14:16). If the Restrainer is taken out of the way, the church is taken out with Him.

The mystery of lawlessness

2 Thessalonians 2:7a · I.B — The demonic activity



Already at work
ἐνεργέω G1754

- Satan’s power operating now
- Same root in v.9 and v.11

Only God can restrain it

- Satan is the mightiest angel
- Michael: “The Lord rebuke you” (Jude 9)

When, who, why

2 Thessalonians 2:8–10 · II — The prophetic climax

When · v.8
ἐπιφάνεια brightness of His coming

- Revealed after the removal
- Consumed by the breath of His mouth
- Destroyed at Christ’s coming

Who · vv.9–10a
σημεῖον · τέρας signs · wonders

- According to the working of Satan
- Lying wonders imitate the Messiah
- Deceiving those who perish

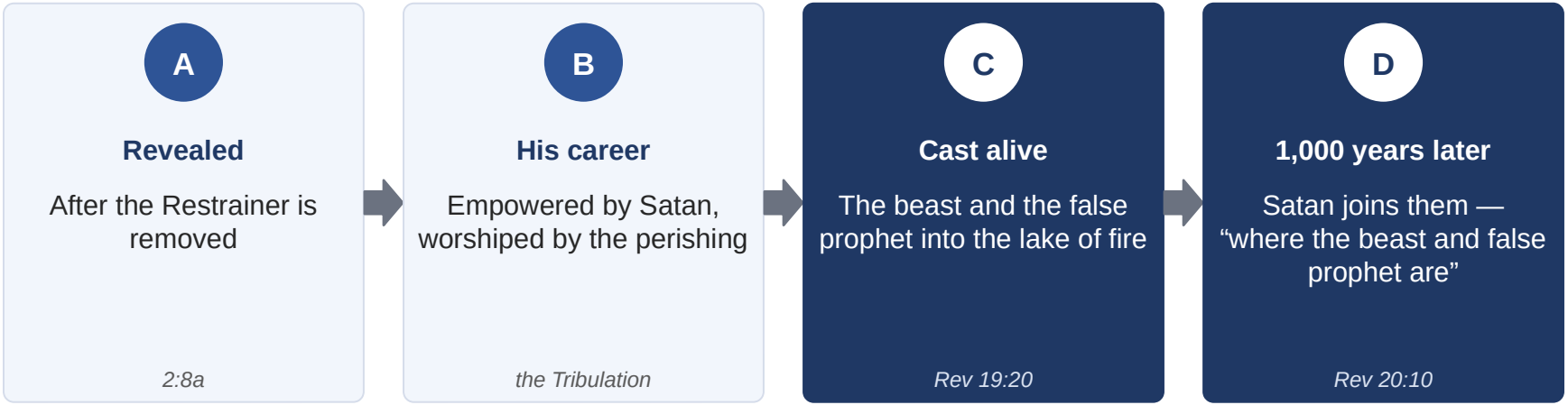
Why · v.10b
ἀπάτη deception · G539

- “They did not receive the love of the truth”
- They traded the cross for the show

Verse 8 is his whole career in three lines: he comes up, he rebels, he is thrown into the lake of fire.

God wins

2 Thessalonians 2:8 · II.A.2–3 — Revelation 19:20 and 20:10



“I looked at the last page: He wins. And we’re winning with Him.”

Delusion, damnation — and a question

2 Thessalonians 2:11–12 · III — The practical conclusion

Delusion and damnation
πλάνη · ψεῦδος delusion · the lie

- Strong delusion — a working of error
- They believe the lie: the Antichrist is God
- Condemned — declared and deserved

vs

Can those left behind believe?
“a great multitude” Rev 7:9

- Yes — the 144,000 and a great multitude
- But many take the mark — no turning back
- Eternal life is always by faith in Christ

All rejection of Christ’s offer of eternal life — offered at the cost of His own life — deserves eternal punishment. All judgment is given to the Son (John 5:27).

Discuss and apply

2 Thessalonians 2:6–12 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. Why does the teacher identify the Restrainer as the Holy Spirit indwelling the church?

2. Why will the Antichrist work signs and wonders, and how does the teacher connect this to some miracle workers today?

Apply

Don’t Be Impressed by the Show
When you hear a claim of the miraculous this week, ask first what it teaches about Jesus and the gospel.

Remember Who Wins
Read Revelation 19:11–20:10 and thank God specifically for each victory Christ wins.

In one line: The Spirit in the church holds back lawlessness until He is taken out of the way — and then Christ destroys the lawless one. He wins.

Study 5 of 7 · 2 Thessalonians 2:13–17

The Day of the Lord and Believers

In contrast to the unbelievers who will face the Day of the Lord, believers are loved, chosen, set apart and appointed to deliverance — so stand fast and hold the apostolic Word.

Their position — 2:13–14

2 Thessalonians 2:13–14 · I.A–D

Situation · 13a
ἀγαπάω beloved

- Brothers of Paul
- Beloved by the Lord

Selection · 13b
αἱρέομαι chose

- The Father chose
- The Spirit set apart
- They believed the truth

Salvation · 13c
σωτηρία deliverance

- Deliverance — here, from the wrath of the Tribulation

Glorification · 14
περιποίησις obtaining

- Called by “our gospel”
- To share Christ’s glory

“But” (2:13) — they are going to be in it; not you. Verse 12: condemned who did not believe the truth. Verse 13: you believed the truth.

“God … chose you” — which word?

2 Thessalonians 2:13b · I.B.1 — The Father chose

2 Thess 2:13 — haireomai
αἱρέομαι to pick, choose · G138

- Used of picking fruit
- Elsewhere only Phil 1:22; Heb 11:25
- “From the beginning” of the gospel there
- Chosen to escape the Tribulation

vs

Ephesians 1:4 — eklegomai
ἐξελέξατο He chose us · election

- “Before the foundation of the world”
- Choosing to eternal life
- The teacher still holds it firmly
- — but doesn’t see it here

The Father chose, the Holy Spirit conferred (“sanctification by the Spirit”), and the Thessalonians concurred (“belief in the truth”).

Three tenses of sanctification

2 Thessalonians 2:13 · I.B.2 — “through sanctification by the Spirit”

A

Past — a position

Set apart to God the moment we believe

Paul’s main point here

B

Present — a process

Transformed by the Word and the Spirit

John 17:17 · 2 Cor 3:18

C

Future — a prospect

“We shall be like Him”

1 John 3:2

ἁγιασμός sanctification — here mainly the positional setting apart by the Spirit

Paul may have all three in mind — but mainly our past sanctification, which placed us into the body of Christ.

Salvation means deliverance — from what?

2 Thessalonians 2:13c · I.C — Their salvation

A **Spiritual**

From sin’s penalty, power and presence

B **Physical**

“They were healed” — delivered from blindness, lameness

C **Circumstances**

Peter sinking: “Lord, save me!” (Matt 14:30)

D **Matthew 24:13**

Enduring through the Tribulation — not keeping eternal life

E **1 Thess 5:9**

“Not appointed to wrath, but to obtain salvation”

✓ **Here · 2:13**

Deliverance from the wrath of the Tribulation

Stand fast and hold the Word

2 Thessalonians 2:15 · II.A — Our responsibility



Hold the traditions
παράδοσις G3862

- By word — what Paul taught in person
- By epistle — what he wrote

Apostolicity = canonicity

- When the apostles were gone, the canon was closed
- John 14:26; 16:13

Our resources

2 Thessalonians 2:16–17 · II.B — Their source and content

The source · 16a

- “Our Lord Jesus Christ Himself, and our God and Father”
- “Who” — singular: one God
- According to His riches (Phil 4:19)

God’s love · 16b

παράκλησις · ἐλπίς consolation · hope

- Everlasting consolation
- A good hope, by grace
- No charge

God’s life · 17

στηρίζω establish · G4741

- Comforts your hearts
- Establishes you in every good word and work

Your hope is not in this government or the Constitution. Your hope is in the Lord — a good hope that assures you of the return of your victorious Savior.

Discuss and apply

2 Thessalonians 2:13–17 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. How should we determine the meaning of “salvation,” and what does it mean in 2:13?

2. What five things does the teacher say we must do with the Word so that it does not slip away?

Apply

Read “Saved” in Context
Work through the handout passages this week, asking “saved from what?” for each one.

Five Steps to Holding the Word
Write down one truth, review it daily, and share it with one person before next week.

In one line: Loved, chosen, set apart and appointed to deliverance — so stand fast, hold the Word, and draw on His love, comfort and good hope.

Study 6 of 7 · 2 Thessalonians 3:1–12

Serving While Waiting

What do you do while you’re waiting? Wait on the Lord in prayer, and wait for the Lord in work — the Word must run, and idleness must not become meddling.

Wait on the Lord — wait for the Lord

2 Thessalonians 3:1–12 · Outline I–II

I · Wait on the Lord · 3:1–5

- The content of the prayer — ministry and misery
- The confidence of the prayer — the Lord is faithful
- The consequences of the prayer — love and patience

+

II · Wait for the Lord · 3:6–12

- The exhortation — withdraw
- The example — Paul’s own work
- The explanation — busybodies
- The solution — work in quietness

Trust and obey: “Fear God and keep His commandments” (Eccl 12:13) — pray and trust; work and obey.

“Pray for us”

2 Thessalonians 3:1–2 · I.A — The content of the prayer

Their ministry · v.1

τρέχω run swiftly · G5143

- That the Word may run — it has no feet
- And be glorified — believed, prized
- “Just as it is with you”

Their misery · v.2

ἄτοπος · πονηρός out of place · harmful

- Deliverance from unreasonable, wicked men
- “For not all have faith”
- They oppose the gift and the giver

Satan doesn’t bother those who don’t bother him. Let’s start bothering Satan — and that will be giving the Word.

“But the Lord is faithful”

2 Thessalonians 3:3–4 · I.B — The confidence of the prayer

A

He will establish you

Strengthened in the faith as you study His Book

v.3a

B

He will guard you

From the evil one — and from evil

φυλάσσω · πονηρός · v.3b

C

You will do

What you are doing — and continue

v.4

pistis → pistos: “not all have faith … but the Lord is faithful” (3:2–3)

Ryrie: could you stop at an accident and lead a dying man to the Lord? Know the faith — and stand in it.

Into God’s love and Christ’s patience

2 Thessalonians 3:5 · I.C — The consequences of the prayer

The love of God · 5a

κατευθύνω direct · G2720

- “God so loved the world”
- Love for the unlovely
- Even unlovely Christians

The patience of Christ · 5b

1. **Philip — John 14:8–9**
   “Have I been with you so long, and you still don’t know?”

2. **James and John**
   The Sons of Thunder: “Shall we call down fire?”

3. **Peter — Matthew 16**
   From a revelation from heaven to “Get behind Me, Satan!”

God’s love to love people, and Christ’s patience to work with them — until the good news gets passed on.

Exhortation and example

2 Thessalonians 3:6–10 · II.A–B — Wait for the Lord

A **The order · v.6**

Withdraw from the brother who walks disorderly (στέλλω · ἀτάκτως)

B **Integrity · v.7**

“Do as I do, because I do as I say” (μιμέομαι)

C **Industry · v.8**

Night and day — no one’s bread free of charge

D **Intention · v.9**

He had the right (ἐξουσία) — and laid it aside as an example

E **Intimation · v.10**

“If anyone will not work, neither shall he eat”

! **“Forgive me this wrong!”**

Paul to Corinth: his one “fault” — he was no burden (2 Cor 12:13)

Not busy at work — busybodies

2 Thessalonians 3:11–12 · II.C–D — The explanation and the solution

The problem · v.11
περιεργάζομαι busybodies · G4020

- Able to work — but would not
- Spare time turned into meddling
- Interrupting those who were working

vs

The solution · v.12
ἡσυχία quietness · G2271

- Work in quietness
- Eat your own bread
- Said in person, in 1 Thess 4:11, and here

“Eat what’s put before you, and let it stop your mouth.” — the teacher’s mother, to six children in the Depression

Discuss and apply

2 Thessalonians 3:1–12 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. What does it mean for the Word to “run” and to be “glorified,” and how can we help it run where we cannot go?

2. What was the real problem with those who would not work, and how did Paul’s example answer it?

Apply

Put Legs Under Your Prayers
Choose one missionary your church supports and pray for them by name every day this week.

Work Quietly While You Wait
When tempted to comment on someone else’s affairs, turn that moment into a prayer for them instead.

In one line: While we wait: pray that the Word runs, trust the faithful Lord, and work quietly — trust and obey.

Study 7 of 7 · 2 Thessalonians 3:13–18

My Brother’s Keeper

Am I my brother’s keeper? Yes. Don’t grow weary in doing good, admonish the disobedient brother as family — and rest in the Lord of peace and the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ.

Five closing words

2 Thessalonians 3:13–18 · Outline I–V

A **Confirmation · v.13**

“Do not grow weary in doing good”

B **Admonition · vv.14–15**

Note him, withdraw — but admonish him as a brother

C **Benediction · v.16**

“The Lord of peace Himself give you peace always”

D **Validation · v.17**

“With my own hand, which is a sign in every epistle”

E **Salutation · v.18**

“The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you all”

✓ **Yes**

I am my brother’s keeper — and my sister’s

Help, don’t enable

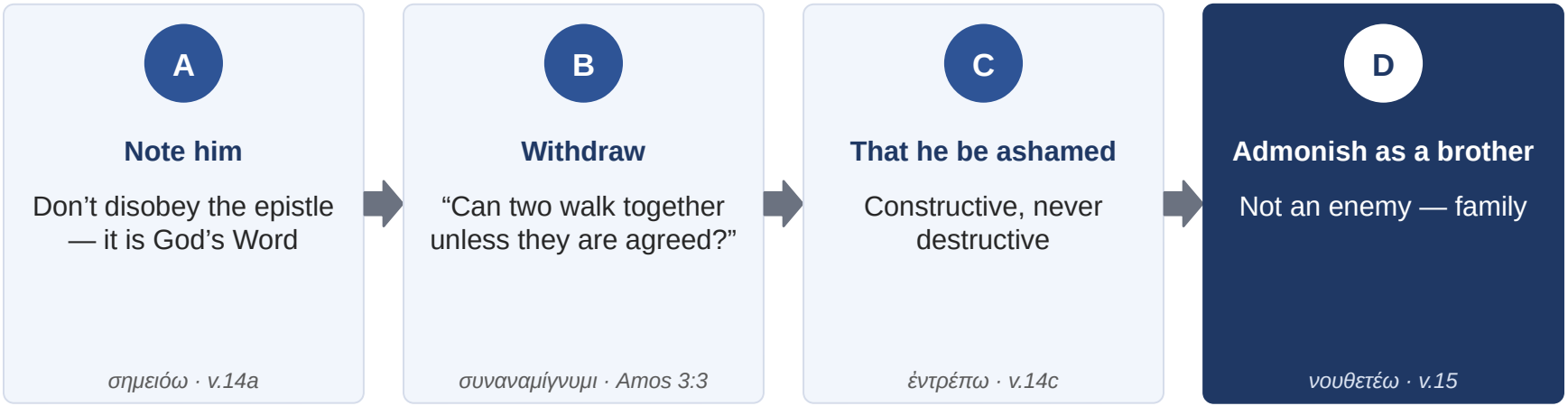
Introduction and I · Confirmation — 3:13

Enabling		Helping **καλοποιέω** doing good · G2569
• “Helping” someone keep doing wrong • Like money that buys drugs • Some fed the idle and their meddling	vs	• Work and care for your family • Do the work of the church • Don’t grow weary (ἐκκακέω)

Even when you grow tired in doing good, don’t grow tired of doing good. Keep on keeping on.

Withdraw — but as family

2 Thessalonians 3:14–15 · II — Admonition



He is still a “brother” (3:6, 15). Withdrawal addresses his fellowship, not his eternal life — relationship is settled at faith; fellowship is restored by confession (1 John 1:9).

“Brother Horatio …”

2 Thessalonians 3:15b · II.B.2 — Counsel him as family

Before you go

- The Lord lays it on your heart
- You’re convinced it’s your assignment
- You have prayed hard
- He gives you a clear path

When you go

1. **“Brother Horatio, we’re brothers.”**
   Children of God — start with the relationship
2. **“I’m concerned about you …”**
   Then name the area — name the offense
3. **“May I show you in the Word?”**
   Ask permission; if no, take the next step (Matt 18)

“Make sure I don’t get to be an enemy by the way I handle the job the Lord gave me.”

Peace three ways

2 Thessalonians 3:16 · III — Benediction

Peace with God

- Justified by faith
- Settled and guaranteed
- Rom 5:1

The peace of God

- Be anxious for nothing — pray
- Peter asleep in prison (Acts 12)
- Phil 4:6–7

The God of peace

- “I will never leave you” — Heb 13:5
- With you always — Matt 28:20
- “With you all”

εἰρήνη Peace with God is guaranteed. The peace of God is something we ask for — we let our requests be known to Him, and leave it there.

Signed by hand — sealed with grace

2 Thessalonians 3:17–18 · IV–V — Validation and salutation

Validation · v.17
ἀσπασμός · σημεῖον salutation · sign

- Paul signs with his own hand
- “A sign in every epistle”
- The test against the forged letter (2:2)

vs

Salutation · v.18
χάρις grace · G5485

- Saving grace — Eph 2:8–9
- Sharing grace — 2 Cor 8:7
- Serving grace — Heb 12:28

Am I my brother’s keeper? Yes — and he is my brother, not my enemy. The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you all.

Discuss and apply

2 Thessalonians 3:13–18 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. What is the difference between helping a brother and enabling him, and how does this connect to the idle Thessalonians?

2. What is the purpose of church discipline in 3:14–15?

Apply

Help, Don’t Enable
Ask the Lord whether any of your help has become enabling, and what real help would look like.

Never, Ever Alone
Each evening, write down one worry, pray it through Philippians 4:6–7, and leave it there.

In one line: Yes, I am my brother’s keeper — keep doing good, restore him as family, and rest in the Lord of peace and His grace.

Conclusion · 2 Thessalonians 1–3

Grace at the beginning, grace at the end

A suffering church reminded who it is, steadied about the coming of the Lord, and taught to serve while it waits — framed from first to last by grace and peace. “The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you all.”